

select the *Unfolding* entry. An *AutoUV* window opens to show the part that is unwrapped and ready to be turned into a texture file.

However, do not be in a hurry.

Before we actually get down to painting the plane, unwrap and place all the unwrapped maps away from each other, to avoid overlapping and confusion later on. As you unwrap, part by part, keep the parts separate. Later, you could rotate and scale the parts individually, before bringing them back to the highlighted square—which is where your texture map will be actually created.

Figures 12 to 20 show you how the unwrapping was done, part by part, and how all the unwrapped parts were brought together to the central square, where the texture map will be generated.

Creating the texture and saving it

Once you have unwrapped all the different parts of the plane, scale them, rotate them, and arrange them in the central square, which you can save as your texture file. A look at Figure 20 shows how all the unwrapped segments are brought together.

Figures 21 to 23 show the process of saving the texture to a file. Open the *Outliner*, right-click the entry that says *cube1_auv*, and export it to a file (the file format could be whatever is convenient to you, the artist). The default file name for the texture is usually *cube1_auv* in case the basic geometry used was a cube, and the default format is BMP.

Now, let's move to the GIMP to paint the texture.

Painting the texture and applying it

Before firing up the GIMP, a few words about it. Of late, the GIMP has developed a lot, especially

with versions 2.6 and later. It is frequently compared to Photoshop, and is fondly called 'Photoshop for free'; mind you, this is not an exaggeration! The GIMP can perform all the functions that Photoshop can; it is only a bad carpenter who blames his tools.

Start the GIMP, and open the BMP texture file. Start painting the texture, according to your whim and fancy, as I have done (look at Figures 24 to 26). Figure 25 shows a test render from my initial painting.

The steps for importing the painted BMP image into Wings3D are simple. Just open the *Outliner* and right-click the texture that you made *external* and saved as a BMP file. Click the *Refresh* option. The texture shows up right there in the *Outliner*. If you want the texture to be visible in your Wings3D viewport, look for the *Make Internal* option and click it. You will see your plane textured, with the 2D texture file wrapping your 3D model.



Note: Your texture will not show up if you have not provided a diffused material before mapping your object.

You can render the model (for preview/testing) in Wings3D itself, using OpenGL, the default rendering engine. You can also get a render preview in Blender, or any other 3D application of your choice, provided you export the model as a Wavefront object, which is universally accepted.

Figure 27 shows you the final rendering of the plane, after some more painting of the texture map. So, that is it, folks! Here ends the brief tutorial on mapping and texturing the plane that we created in our first tutorial carried in *LFY's* October 2010 issue. 

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